

Daily Bible Note

Date: July 28, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 32:17-32

17 It came to pass also in the twelfth year, on the fifteenth day of the month, that the word of the Lord came to me, saying:

18 "Son of man, wail over the multitude of Egypt, And cast them down to the depths of the earth, Her and the daughters of the famous nations, With those who go down to the Pit:

19 'Whom do you surpass in beauty? Go down, be placed with the uncircumcised.'

20 "They shall fall in the midst of those slain by the sword; She is delivered to the sword, Drawing her and all her multitudes.

21 The strong among the mighty Shall speak to him out of the midst of hell With those who help him: 'They have gone down, They lie with the uncircumcised, slain by the sword.'

22 "Assyria is there, and all her company, With their graves all around her, All of them slain, fallen by the sword.

23 Her graves are set in the recesses of the Pit, And her company is all around her grave, All of them slain, fallen by the sword, Who caused terror in the land of the living.

24 "There is Elam and all her multitude, All around her grave, All of them slain, fallen by the sword, Who have gone down uncircumcised to the lower parts of the earth, Who caused their terror in the land of the living; Now they bear their shame with those who go down to the Pit.

25 They have set her bed in the midst of the slain, With all her multitude, With her graves all around it, All of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword; Though their terror was caused In the land of the living, Yet they bear their shame With those who go down to the Pit; It was put in the midst of the slain.

26 "There are Meshech and Tubal and all their multitudes, With all their graves around it, All of them uncircumcised, slain by the sword, Though they caused their terror in the land of

the living.

27 They do not lie with the mighty Who are fallen of the uncircumcised, Who have gone down to hell with their weapons of war; They have laid their swords under their heads, But their iniquities will be on their bones, Because of the terror of the mighty in the land of the living.

28 Yes, you shall be broken in the midst of the uncircumcised, And lie with those slain by the sword.

29 "There is Edom, Her kings and all her princes, Who despite their might Are laid beside those slain by the sword; They shall lie with the uncircumcised, And with those who go down to the Pit.

30 There are the princes of the north, All of them, and all the Sidonians, Who have gone down with the slain In shame at the terror which they caused by their might; They lie uncircumcised with those slain by the sword, And bear their shame with those who go down to the Pit.

31 "Pharaoh will see them And be comforted over all his multitude, Pharaoh and all his army, Slain by the sword," Says the Lord God.

32 "For I have caused My terror in the land of the living; And he shall be placed in the midst of the uncircumcised With those slain by the sword, Pharaoh and all his multitude," Says the Lord God.

II. Key Summary

- After the fall of Jerusalem, God tells Ezekiel to wail over Egypt: Egypt and Pharaoh are cast down to the depths of the earth, laid among those who go down to the Pit.
- The passage names one fallen power after another already down there — Assyria, Elam, Meshech, Tubal, Edom, Sidon, and the princes of the north — repeating that they "caused terror in the land of the living" and now "bear their shame with those who go down to the Pit."
- At the end, Pharaoh sees them and is "comforted" over his own slain army; the whole passage closes with God saying, "For I have caused My terror in the land of the living."

III. Passage Analysis

The Terror You Cause Comes Back as Shame

Because of all the evil these great powers did while they lived — "who caused terror in the land of the living" — they now share one and the same fate: cast down to Sheol, remembered by no one, "bearing their shame with those who go down to the Pit." Egypt will not escape it either. [1]

Assyria, Elam, and Edom all ran on the same strategy: make everyone afraid of you. The passage names them one by one with the same line, showing that the standing they bought with fear leaves them nothing in the Pit but shame.

"Everyone Else Fell Too" Is No Real Comfort

with the melancholy satisfaction of not being alone, but of having other kingdoms companions in his downfall. This shall be his only comfort—a very poor one! [2]

Pharaoh's one consolation is discovering that others ended up just as badly. The passage uses that picture to make a point: "everybody does it" may sound like relief, but nothing has actually changed.

IV. Reflection Question

When you have some influence — friends listen to you, people care what you think — what do you usually do with it?

The powers in this passage once made everyone afraid, and all they carry in the end is shame; the question God asks is what you did with the power you had.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website (ccbiblestudy.org), Concordance Bible Commentary (《串珠聖經註釋》),
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT32.htm>

[2] BibleHub.com, Jamieson-Fausset-Brown Bible Commentary,
<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/32-31.htm>